

Aegis Drone Systems

Drone inspection for ports, transmission lines and plantation estates

Seed round, July 2026

Kochi, Kerala

The problem

- Inspecting a wharf crane means a rope access team, a shutdown, and three days.
- Inspecting 40 km of 132 kV line means a patrol on foot and a subjective report.
- Most owners inspect on a calendar, not on condition, because condition is expensive to know.
- The failures that matter happen between inspections.

What we do

- Automated flight plans over the asset, repeated identically every cycle.
- Defect detection on the imagery, with every finding located and measured.
- A report the asset owner's engineer can act on, delivered in 72 hours.
- 46 inspection cycles delivered across ports, transmission and plantations.

Why repeatability is the product

- A drone photograph is a commodity. The same flight path flown twelve times is not.
- Change between cycles is what tells an owner whether a crack is growing.
- Our flight plans are stored per asset, so cycle twelve is comparable to cycle one.
- This is why the two customers who came back are worth more than the twelve who did not.

Traction

- Rs 1.10 crore revenue in FY26, up from Rs 22 lakh in FY25.
- 14 clients including Cochin Port Authority, KSEB and Harrisons Malayalam.
- Average project value Rs 2.39 lakh, contribution 42.3 percent.
- Three annual retainers in negotiation, none signed yet.

The honest gap

- Everything to date is project revenue. Nothing recurs.
- Two of 14 clients have come back for a second cycle.
- This is the problem the round is meant to fix, and we are not going to dress it up.
- Our target is three signed retainers before the end of Q3 FY27.

Regulatory

- DGCA BVLOS permission applied for on 2 March 2026, still pending.
- Within visual line of sight operations are fully permitted and cover ports and estates.
- Transmission line inspection at scale needs BVLOS, and that pipeline is the largest.
- Chief pilot is a DGCA certified remote pilot instructor with 1,900 UAS hours.

Business model

- Per cycle pricing today, Rs 1.8 lakh to Rs 6.4 lakh depending on asset size.
- Target model is an annual retainer of four cycles at a 15 percent discount to per cycle.
- Retainer converts a Rs 2.4 lakh transaction into an Rs 8.2 lakh relationship.
- Analytics is the margin: the flying is 30 percent of the cost, the reading is 70 percent.

Use of funds

- Rs 5.5 crore, expected to last 16 months.
- Rs 1.8 crore: two additional airframes and a thermal payload.
- Rs 1.6 crore: analytics team, to bring report turnaround from 72 hours to 24.
- Rs 1.4 crore: enterprise sales for retainer conversion.
- Rs 0.7 crore: reserve, including a second insurance layer.

The team

- Rohan Fernandes, CEO. Ran industrial inspection for a Bengaluru drone services company.
- Capt. Ismail Haq, Chief Pilot. Eighteen years flying with the Indian Air Force.
- Meera Nambiar, Head of Analytics. Built rail track defect models for a public sector client.
- 12 full time, including four certified remote pilots.